

Chromium Diet



What is it?

People with allergic contact dermatitis can be so sensitive to their allergen that they must avoid skin exposure AND ingestion (eating) of the chemical. This type of allergy could cause dermatitis on the eyelids, hands, face, around the mouth, or at the skin folds (armpits, groin). Some people may have dermatitis all over their bodies.

For some people allergic to chromium, a diet low in chromium can reduce the likelihood of skin reactions. The level of chromium required to produce a response is unknown and can vary from patient to patient. An 8-12 week trial of removing foods and beverages that contain chromium is recommended.

Chromium is an essential trace element. Because it is in soil and water, it can be incorporated into plants and animals, and subsequently into our food.

The goal is a low-chromium diet.

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

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FOODS TO AVOID

Beverages		
Coffee	Orange Juice	Wine
Grape Juice	Tea	
Cereal		
Bran Cereal	Whole Grains	Whole Grain Flour
Fruit		
Apple	Plum	Prune
Banana		
Legumes		
Baked Beans	Green Beans	Peas
Herbs		
Basil	Cloves	Thyme
Black Pepper		
Meats		
Beef	Turkey	
Vegetables		
Broccoli	Garlic	Potato
Corn	Onion	Watercress
Other		
Brewer's Yeast	Cocoa	Mushrooms
Chocolate	Eggs	Sugar (Raw)

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